Pupil studio resources & worksheet — Framing a site-specific visual brief

Pathway: SUMMIT · Week 1 Part 2 · Big question: How do architects and public artists analyse spatial context, sightlines, and structural form to write a rigorous studio brief?

Arrival check

Why does a site-specific artwork look powerful in the exact square or building it was designed for, yet might look out of place anywhere else?

[ ] Its angles, textures, and scale echo or contrast deliberately with the surrounding architecture

[ ] The designer maps where people walk and stand so the structure frames key sightlines

[ ] Clear material constraints keep the design unified and buildable

Starter visual cues

1. Site & Geometry analysis: Extracting dominant structural vectors (arches, cantilevers, triangulated trusses, voids).

2. Audience & Sightline mapping: How the piece reads from 3 metres (silhouette) vs 30 cm (surface texture).

3. Material & Palette constraints: Specifying three relief levels and a disciplined industrial patina.

4. Visual elevation & Intent statement: Annotated proportional drawing locking the design brief.

Vote: Why is it essential to consider both the 3-metre view and the 30-centimetre view when framing a structural relief brief?

Studio practice planner

Establish the parameters for your site-specific studio brief.

Shapes/Focus: Form: Cantilevered truss span, Form: Interlocking arch void, Form: Vertical lattice tower, Form: Ribbed vault elevation

Tools/Methods: Spec: 3-level laminated card, Spec: Embossed foil gussets, Spec: Monochromatic slate + oxide, Spec: High-relief shadow voids

Exit ticket

Why does a strong structural design brief plan for both the 3-metre view and the 30-centimetre view?

[ ] So the artwork commands attention from afar with a bold silhouette while rewarding close inspection with rich surface texture

[ ] Because rulers only measure 30 centimetres

[ ] To use two separate boards